

INSTITUTE FOR STRATEGIC TECHNOLOGIES

BRIEF

Financing the Defense Tech Transition

Dr. Alan Whitfield · April 2026

Executive Summary

This brief presents IST's analysis of critical technologies shaping the future of U.S. national security. Drawing on rigorous research and high-level engagement with government, industry, and academic partners, this work explores the strategic implications, technical challenges, and policy opportunities in this domain.

The findings presented here are intended to inform decision-makers at the highest levels of government and industry, providing both the technical depth and strategic context necessary for informed policy development and investment decisions.